JASON MOLLINK

Writing Portfolio

Screenwriter · Interactive Narrative · Essayist

INTERACTIVE NARRATIVE

The Owl House in VR

A journey through Helen Martin's last day. A shadow armed with Helen's lantern brings light to the forbidden Owl House, revealing the unsettling world of sculpture, longing and quiet rebellion that she built with Koos Malgas, a fragile collaboration shaped by their shared alienation in Apartheid South Africa.

An immersive film set to premiere at the Venice Film Festival after being selected for an intensive mentorship program with the Venice Biennale Immersive Cinema College in 2025.

Lighting the room reveals a tall, fat man in boxers and a white vest lying on the long bed. On his head is a large box with a depiction of an orange sun. The Little Devil whistles until he gets up and walks to the next room.

BOXMAN
Hhmmph!

Julia's face fades over Boxman's.

JULIA MALGAS NARRATION
Agh, Boxman. You know sometimes you get those people that act like they are blind to the world around them? Ja, Boxman.

Boxman walks into the doorframe before continuing onto the next room.

A Victorian image has an inscription that reads: 'Oh, for the touch of a vanished hand. And the sound of a voice that is still'.

INT. LONG BEDROOM - DAY

The Long Bedroom is multicolored with geometric patterns on the ceiling. Lifting the lantern to another sun illuminates the room and activates a memory.

Helen and Koos paste glass onto the back wall. A glass shard from the top of the wall drifts off, sparkles and falls into Koos's eye.

KOOS MALGAS
Ow! Ow it's in my eye!

HELEN MARTINS
Don't move. I'll bring the water.

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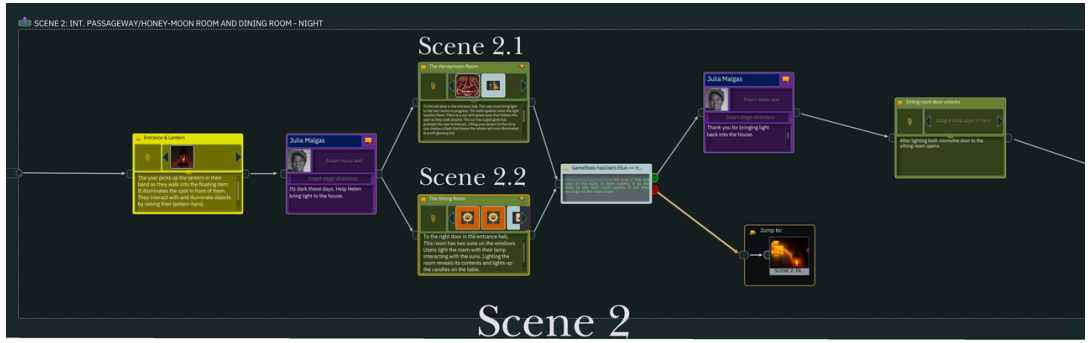
La Biennale di Venezia
Biennale College Cinema VR

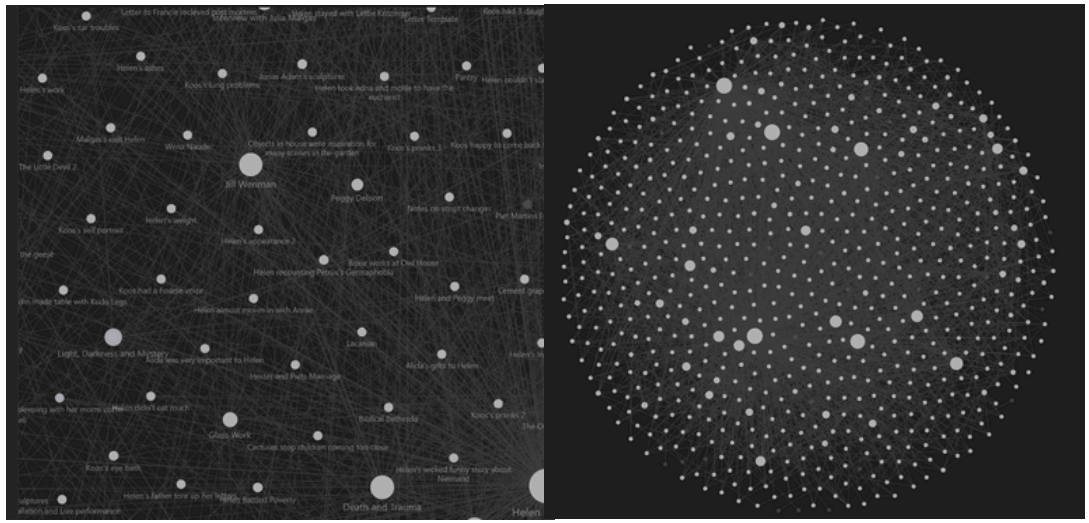
INTERACTIVE NARRATIVE

The Owl House in VR

Continued...



Script written and coded into Articy:draft X for interactive game design.



Interactive research document with hundreds of entries written in Obsidian

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SHORT FILM

Psshhh or Liphi iKhaya Labo

A surreal odyssey into Cape Town's unconscious. A young real estate agent is invited out to the club. After being barred from entering because of his sneakers, he decides to take a pair of smart shiny shoes off a sleeping homeless man. Dark forces pursue him back in the club.

Premiered at the Joburg Underground Film Festival. Screened at Search Music Festival, Joburg Underground Film Festival, and the Gorgeous George Hotel, Cape Town.

EXT. COMPANY GARDENS — NIGHT

Homeless people sleep in pockets of light across the grass. Sibs spots figure — bottom half bathed in lamplight, sticking out from a blanket: pair of shining black derby shoes.

He steps closer. The body lies still as death. After a long moment, removes the man's shoes. Dirty grey socks beneath. He slips off his takkies, leaves them beside the man, puts the new shoes on.

Sibs gives a gentle, tentative smile. A soft whisper breaks the quiet

VOICE
Hey skelm.

Other whispers join. They overlap, amalgamate, become a heavy hissing. Sibs breathes heavily, looks around. Wide-eyed. Frantic. All he sees darkness.

EXT. STREET — NIGHT

Sibs is running. A hand shoots out from an alleyway and pulls him in. The homeless man. He presses a finger to his lips.

HOMELESS MAN
Shhhhhh.

A shot of their feet. Sibs in black derby shoes. The man in Sibs' old New Balances. The man gestures gently down the dark alleyway and takes Sibs by the hand.

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OFFICIAL SELECTION
Joburg Underground Film Festival
2024

SHORT FILM

Rhodes House

The ghosts of Cecil John Rhodes and Jan Smuts haunt an unsuspecting housemate in an old mansion in Cape Town.

Premiered at the Joburg Underground Film Festival.

INT. LIVING ROOM — DAY

Cecil and Jan leaf through old photo albums. Jan's hands rest warmly on Cecil's shoulders.

JAN
We've been haunting this place for eone!

CECIL
Eons, yes. It's been a long time. But I couldn't imagine myself happier anywhere else.

JAN
I do wish we could get along better with Alex, to be honest.

INT. ALEX'S ROOM — DAY [INTERVIEW]

Alex sits alone in front of the camera.

ALEX
Yeah, I was not expecting colonial conquerors for roommates. But that's the price of these luxury houses, I guess.

He shows us ghost-cam footage on his laptop: Jan tickles Alex's nose with a feather duster. Cecil restrains a laugh behind him.

ALEX
They're fucking assholes, honestly.

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WEB-SERIES

Chief Poop Officer

A lowly corporate employee is offered a bizarre path up the ladder: become his company's Chief Poop Officer — overseeing a scheme that exploits parental leave in the most surreal ways imaginable.

INT. OFFICE KITCHEN — DAY

Jack looks around the room trying to avoid eye contact with Babalwa, who sits across from him at the table. The sound of suckling. She is breastfeeding a white child. Jack takes a quick look and stares into the corner.

JACK
Um, I'm just going to the bathroom.

INT. WOMEN'S BATHROOM — DAY

Pitch black. Babalwa flicks the lights on. Twelve round shallow plastic buckets stand in two rows of six on the floor. Jack and Babalwa each hold a baby.

Babalwa gently dunks the first baby. It comes out crying. She holds up to the fluorescent light.

BABALWA
Christopher.

She repeats. One by one. Thando. Lucy. Grace. Jacob. Carl. Kiara. Henno. Mimi. Abdul. Bonica. Bronwyn.

Babalwa nods. She turns. Throws water in Jack's face.

BABALWA
Jack.

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THEORETICAL DISSERTATION

How to Kill Images

Dissertation drawing on Agamben, Debord, Lacan, and Dayan. Argues that our relationship with images is constitutively violent — and that the image always survives.

1. Don Quixote's Imagination

Georgio Agamben names his final chapter in *Profonations*, "The Six Most Beautiful Minutes in the History of Cinema" in dedication to a scene from Orson Welles's never finished *Don Quixote*. The scene is difficult to find and see. It is almost extinct, a metastasised part of a dying film. The fragment I found on YouTube was blurry and full of artefacts. The frames hop and jump around as if they have stage fright about being exhibited. There is no sound, just imagery. I've taken from it a screenshot which appears only for an instance, of a crucified Jesus projected onto the screen. In front is Don Quixote, just risen from his seat to slash out at the image with his sword. There is a void in Jesus's lower half where the Don has ripped the projection sheet. The scene begins as Don Quixote's squire, Sancho Panza, searches for his master in the movie theatre. He makes an effort to sit next to him but the theatre is too packed and he sits next to a little girl. Agamben figures her to be Don Quixote's fated lover, Dulcinea. It is guess work because the scene is never included into the larger narrative. In the novel, Dulcinea is the woman of Don Quixote's dreams. He makes her up to be his lover to fulfil his own chivalric requirement to have a beautiful woman. She doesn't exist in the book but it would be apt for Welles to place her here because this is a scene about the Don and his imagination. It turns out she is not a woman at all. The only person who fits the Don's virtues of virginity and innocence is a child. Don Quixote doesn't notice this, or her; he is completely transfixed by the screen. Recognition of her by Don Quixote, or even by Welles, would mean she could break out of the confines of imagination. But the Don's imagination is on hyper drive and he seems unable to keep it from impinging on the real world. The events on screen are intensifying. He sees a woman in danger as knights encircle her. The Don can't take it anymore and gets up to kill the image. Bewildered by the number of events and characters flying past, he starts swinging indiscriminately. He only manages to hit out at his own shadow blocking the projector.